



Rotary



PRESIDENCY CHRONICLES

**Rotaract Club of
Durgapur Central Presidency**
Sponsored by
Rotary Club of Durgapur Central



**5TH EDITION
SEPTEMBER 2024**



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Date: 22nd September 2024

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Rotary

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Rotaract Club of Durgapur Central Presidency presents

28TH SEPTEMBER 2024

Muktodhara, Naihati New Life Society

ANSWER VARIOUS QUESTIONS
RECEIVE GIFTS AND ENJOY

Zone 1
Rotaract RI District 3240

Rotary

DISTRICT PROJECT RE-THINK

"Children's Drawing Competition"

Saturday
28 September, 2024

Start at
4:00pm - 5:00pm

MUKTODHARA, NAIHATI
NEW LIFE SOCIETY

Rotaract Club of Durgapur Central Presidency
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Rotaract Club of Durgapur Central Presidency

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MEET OUR ROTARACTOR OF THE MONTH September

Rotary | **THE MAGIC OF ROTARY**



SPECIAL EDITOR'S NOTE

Rtr. Debarpito Sarkar

Rotary Year 2024-2025

“ যাবো না এবার মা কে দেখতে, যাবো না এবার কুমারটুলি,
সবাই এস আর জি কর এ, একসাথে আওয়াজ তুলি।
লড়েছে অভয়া, লড়ছি আমরা, থামবেনা আমাদের গলার স্বর,
আমাদের একটাই দাবি, জাস্টিস ফর আর জি কর। ”

The last 70 days represented one of the numerous darkest times of our Generation. Such a horrific incident which took place at R.G. Kar Hospital in Kolkata, shook the entire nation in one blow. Our cries reached the nation, leading to the greatest public movement I have witnessed in my 25 years of existence. For the first time, even when Maa Durga was coming to our home, I felt sadness. But our sadness is nothing compared to what Abhaya's mother and father are feeling. Think about it. Aren't you getting angry just thinking about it? I know. So, this Durga Puja, I will stand by Abhaya, the doctors and the 1 % of our population and not attend Durga Puja. I am sure Maa Durga would do the same if she was here. Can't talk about the remaining 99 % of the population who will go pandel hopping, selfie-clicking and partying with their friends. I am not one of them.

With regards to my protest, I am representing this month's bulletin with the color of the cloud hovering over the City of Joy. Thanks for reading.

Secretary-Administration (2024-25)

Treasurer (2024-25)

Rotaract Club of Durgapur Central Presidency

JUSTICE FOR ABHAYA

TEAM RACDCP 2024-2025



Rtr. Ankita Roy

President (2024-25)

Rotaract Club of Durgapur Central Presidency

The alarming incident at RG Kar Medical College and Hospital, Kolkata created a furore. It led to widespread protests erupting in Kolkata and spreading to larger parts of West Bengal, soon to other parts of India. The tragic rape and murder of a resident doctor at RG Kar Medical College and Hospital, Kolkata awakened a broader sense of conscience in people and increased female agony across the nation. The unfortunate incident has also highlighted the cracks and fissures in India's public healthcare edifice. The absence of a robust public health infrastructure has exposed the country's vulnerability to pandemics, health crises, and even crimes. The public healthcare terrain in India stands parched and neglected, a result of neglect, underfunding, and mismanagement, leaving a trail of scarcity- inadequate medical facilities, essential medicines, equipment, and diagnostic tools, and a crippling shortage of healthcare professionals sternly affecting the fraternity.

As is often the case with high-profile instances of sexual violence, the response from the government authorities has focused on punitive measures while overlooking the deeper structural flaws in the criminal justice system. Following the 2013 amendment of criminal laws in the aftermath of a brutal rape in Delhi, several states such as MP, Rajasthan, Haryana, Andhra Pradesh, Maharashtra, and Arunachal Pradesh have pushed for amendments to impose harsher penalties for sexual assault. The authorities mainly resort to enacting legislations that increase punishments but fail to address the systemic issues that result in low conviction rates and the perpetuation of "rape culture" in India. The recently passed Aparajita Women and Child (West Bengal Criminal Laws Amendment) Bill, 2024 demonstrated as a law that addresses the grave issues of sexual violence. Yet, beneath its façade lies a troubling reality - one marked by populist rhetoric and a hasty response to public outrage.

As a consequence of this horrific tragedy, further unveiled the vengeful transfers and harassment faced by doctors. This unfortunate incident has also exposed the inherent deficiency in public healthcare. The public healthcare fraternity faces significant challenges such as insufficient beds, poor hygiene and cleanliness, inadequate security, neglect of patient care, frequent shortages of essential medicines and consumables, and corrupt practices among staff. Basic utilities such as water, electricity, and fuel are also often lacking. Furthermore, ambulance services are frequently unavailable due to breakdowns or corruption, leaving patients to fend for themselves. Rural healthcare workers face numerous work-related challenges, severely impacting their efficiency and well-being. Overwork and long hours are common due to staff shortages, with many workers handling excessive patient loads. Inadequate training and capacity building hinder their ability to provide quality care, while limited career advancement opportunities stifle professional growth. Poor working conditions, including inadequate infrastructure, insufficient medical supplies, and outdated equipment, further complicate their tasks. Additionally, rural healthcare workers often confront administrative hurdles, bureaucratic delays, and a lack of standardization in protocols and procedures.

In 2020, during the mid-term review of progress on the Decade for Health Workforce Strengthening in 2015-2024, the WHO mentioned that India needs at least 1.8 million doctors, nurses, and midwives to achieve the minimum threshold of 44.5 professional health workers per 10,000 population.

In 2016, The WHO Global Strategy on Human Resources for Health: Workforce 2030 highlighted that "Health systems can only function with health workers; improving health service coverage and realizing the right to the enjoyment of the highest attainable standard of health is dependent on their availability, accessibility, acceptability, and quality.

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The Health Dynamics of India (Infrastructure and Human Resources) 2022-23 Report released by the Ministry of Health and Family Welfare, shows a staggering deficiency in India's healthcare infrastructure, particularly in terms of its workforce. The report reveals a significant shortage of skilled healthcare professionals, including doctors, nurses, and other categories of healthcare workers such as anesthesiologists, lab-technicians, & radiographers, posing a substantial threat to the already overburdened healthcare system. The unequal access to healthcare services has far-reaching consequences, namely perpetuating the vicious cycles of poverty and disadvantage where those with the means to afford private healthcare are able to access superior services, while the marginalized and vulnerable populations are relegated to suboptimal care.

Recommendations: -

1) To conduct a thorough examination to determine the underlying root causes contributing to the shortage of Human Resources for Health (HRH) in urban and rural healthcare centers, utilizing reports on Infrastructure and Human Resources from government and private sources.

2) To analyze the impact of Government policies and regulations on HRH recruitment, retention, and practice and investigate the working conditions, job satisfaction, workload, burnout, well-being, and work-life balance of HRH in urban and rural areas and thereafter provide actionable recommendations to address the identified root causes and improve HRH availability and retention.

3) Mitigative measures to combat the shortage of HRH namely by introducing telemedicine facilities to increase access to healthcare services, especially in rural areas, conducting targeted recruitment campaigns to attract healthcare professionals to urban and rural areas, and developing digital health platforms to enhance access and efficiency.

4) To clarify the scope of practice and enhance the role of non-physician healthcare workers, including community health workers, through training, task delegation, and improved employment conditions, such as higher wages and better working environments.

5) To address systemic issues by improving training and education infrastructure by fostering collaborations between government, private sector, and educational institutions. To promote flexible work arrangements and career development opportunities among medical students.

6) To set up internal review mechanisms to address grievances about recruitment processes, eligibility criteria, and selection methods before escalating to litigation.

7) Rural healthcare must be improved by streamlining the recruitment of medical professionals, implementing telemedicine, and regularly upgrading facilities, equipment, and technology. First-level referral hospitals should provide basic specialist care in pediatrics, gynecology, obstetrics, general medicine, surgery, dental services, ophthalmology, and diagnostics. Essential services include immunization, maternity care (pregnancy, abortion, delivery, postnatal), supply of rational drugs, epidemiological services (lab work, disease surveillance), contraceptive services, and ambulance support. Public health initiatives should be guided by continuous surveys and efficient information management.

SL	Name of Committee	Year
1	Bhore Committee	1946
2	Col.S. S. Sokhey on National Health, National Planning Committee Series	1948
3	Udapa K.N. Committee on Ayurveda Research Evaluation	1958
4	Mudaliar Committee	1962
5	Chadha Committee	1963
6	Mukherjee Committee	1965-1966
7	Jungalwalla Committee	1967
8	Kartar Singh Committee	1973
9	Shrivastav Committee	1975

JUSTICE FOR ABHAYA

TEAM RACDCP 2024-2025

The Standing Committees on Health and Family Welfare have time to time rendered valuable recommendations on topics such as the Quality of Medical Education in India, Medical Devices: Regulation and Control, Functioning of the Medical Council of India (MCI), Review of National Ayush Mission, etc.

In its wisdom and foresight, the Hon'ble Supreme Court upheld the guidelines formulated by the Lilamoy Ghose Enquiry Committee in the case of Paschim Banga Khet Major Samiti -versus- State of West Bengal reported in (1996) 4 SCC 37, reiterated unequivocal and detailed directives aimed at enhancing the quality and accessibility of public healthcare services. Regrettably, the State has failed to effectively implement them to date. Such a gap between judicial intent and administrative reality has resulted in a deplorable state of public health and safety.

The safety of rural community health workers in India remains a pressing concern, as they face numerous threats while providing essential healthcare services. Vulnerable groups namely female healthcare workers, workers in conflict-affected areas, and workers providing reproductive and maternal health services, are subject to physical and sexual harassment, verbal abuse, and intimidation from patients, families, and community members. Working in remote and isolated areas, often without reliable transportation or communication, further increases their susceptibility to harm.



Rtr. Monimoy Ghosh

Director - Club Service (2024-25)

Rotaract Club of Durgapur Central Presidency

Addressing Violence Against Women: What We Can Do as a Society to Prevent Incidents Like the R.G. Kar Case

The tragic incident at the R.G. Kar Medical College and Hospital in Kolkata on August 9, 2024, where a 31-year-old female postgraduate trainee doctor was sexually assaulted, raped and brutally murdered, has shaken the conscience of the entire nation. The incident not only highlights the persistent problem of gender-based violence but also underscores the pressing need to take more effective measures to safeguard women, especially in workplaces.

The nation's response has been truly unprecedented, with Bengal likely witnessing the largest spontaneous mass uprising since Independence. Civilians have come together in peaceful protests, expressing their emotions through marches and creative outlets like slogans, street art, and dance. People from all backgrounds and ages took to the streets for the 'Reclaim the Night' movement, and Kolkata's air echoed with a unified chant: 'We demand justice.' In the face of no satisfactory action from the state government, the Bengal medics are currently on a hunger strike to press for their demands of basic safety in workplaces.

While laws, policies, and institutional changes are essential, these are not always within our control as common people. As members of the society and more importantly as Rotaractors, we must take responsibility for creating an environment where women feel safe and respected.

Rather than solely depending on institutional and governmental action, there are critical steps we can take as individuals, families, and communities to address the root causes of gender-based violence. Let's have a look at the ways we can collectively work towards a more secure future.

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TEAM RACDCP 2024-2025

1) Challenging Gender Stereotypes: Gender biases and patriarchal norms are deeply ingrained in our society, leading to objectification of women. We should actively challenge these perceptions, starting from home and extending to the whole society.

a) Educating Children from an Early Age: Parents, guardians, and teachers must teach children—both boys and girls—about respect, consent, and equality from an early age. It is crucial to challenge stereotypes that promote the idea that women are weak or submissive.

b) Reevaluating Gender Roles: As a society, we should actively question traditional gender roles and promote equal opportunities in all spheres of life, from education to employment to household responsibilities. Encouraging both men and women to share responsibilities equally sets a positive example.

c) Media Literacy: Whether it's films, TV shows, or advertisements, the content we engage with often reinforces negative stereotypes for portrayal of women characters. Promoting positive representations of women can contribute to changing perceptions.

2) Promoting a Culture of Empathy and Respect: One of the key elements to preventing harassment and violence is fostering a culture of respect and empathy. Each interaction, whether in public or private, contributes to the way society views and treats women.

a) Respect Boundaries: Every individual must try to understand and respect personal boundaries, more so in public places. This includes asking for consent, refrain from unsolicited advances and respecting a woman's autonomy.

b) Empathy in action: If someone shares their experience of harassment or discomfort, it's important to listen and validate their emotions, rather than dismiss them or shift blame.

3) Standing Up as Bystanders: Mostly, acts of harassments occur in public places, and more often than not, bystanders choose to remain silent. However, society can play a powerful role in preventing violence by encouraging active bystander intervention.

a) Be responsible: If you think that someone is being harassed, don't remain silent. Instead, check in with the person to ask if they are okay. Small action like this can help deter an aggressor.

b) Support victims: If someone comes to you with their experience of harassment, offer them support without judgment. This could mean helping them report the incident, providing emotional support, or simply validating their experience.

4) Changing Perceptions About Masculinity: Much of gender-based violence stems from toxic masculinity—the idea that men must be dominant, aggressive, or entitled. Society needs to shift the way it defines masculinity to encourage healthier and more respectful behavior towards women.

a) Redefining Strength: We need to shift away from associating male strength with dominance or control over women. Instead, we should promote emotional intelligence, empathy, and respect as markers of true strength.

b) Men as Allies: Men can play a crucial role in addressing gender violence by calling out harmful behavior among their peers. It is essential for men to challenge locker-room talk, jokes that objectify women, or any behavior that diminishes the value of women.

c) Creating Safe Spaces for Vulnerability: Society often pressures men to hide vulnerability, which can manifest in aggression. Encouraging open emotional expression and providing supportive environments for men can lead to healthier interactions with others, especially women.

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5) Creating Safe and Inclusive Communities: Communities play a fundamental role in ensuring safety. By working together, neighborhoods, social circles, and families can create environments where women feel protected and respected.

a) Form Community Support Networks: Communities can establish neighborhood safety networks where individuals keep an eye on each other's well-being, especially in public spaces. For instance, if someone is walking home late at night, ensuring they are accompanied or checked on can make a difference.

b) Inclusive Social Spaces: When planning community events or gatherings, it's important to create spaces where all genders feel included and respected. Having women involved in organizing and decision-making ensures their needs and safety concerns are addressed.

Conclusion: A Collective Commitment to Change

The tragic R.G. Kar incident reminds us that the responsibility to protect women cannot rest solely on institutions. As a society, we must actively work towards fostering a culture of respect, empathy, and gender equality. Every individual has the power to make a difference by challenging harmful behaviors, supporting victims, and promoting healthy gender dynamics.

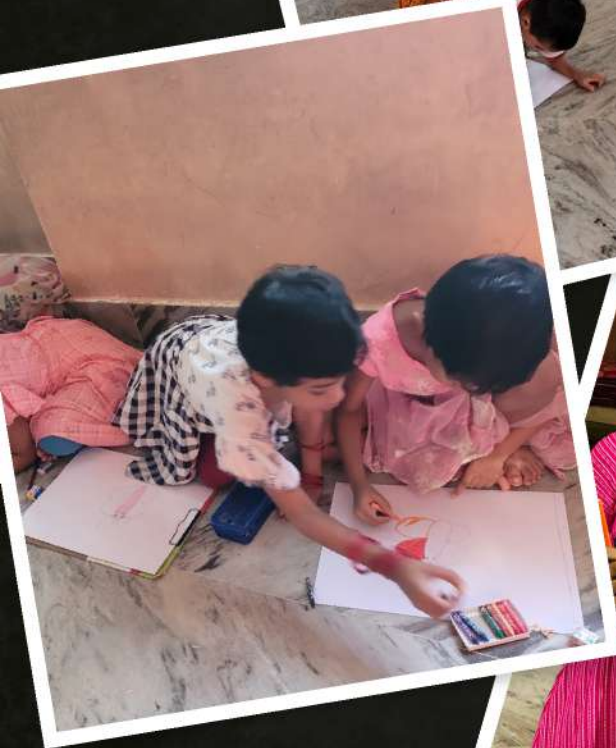
By addressing the root causes of violence against women and taking collective responsibility, we can create a future where women feel safe, valued, and empowered. Real change begins with each of us, in our homes, communities, and daily lives.

To new beginnings

Rota year 24-25

Events in September

Every new beginning
is an opportunity for
a new magic.



Team Durgapur Central
Presidency all decked up for
the new tenure.

District Literacy Project Vinayam

On 22nd September 2024, our Secretary-Events Rtr. Pratiruti Dutta organized the District Project Vinayam at Ganga Brick Factory, Kankinara Naihati. Our aim was to educate the women working at the factory about menstrual hygiene and remove the stigma. But firstly, we served 80 food packets to kids and their mothers. After food distribution was completed, we sat with 12 of the women workers of the Brick factory and started conversing. We enquire about their daily activities and how their lifestyle is. We tried to communicate with them if they're facing any challenges with regards to their daily activities or their day-to-day chores. We enquire about their jobs and whether they're interested in engaging in jobs or earnings. We enquire about their health and hygiene. We enquire about their menstrual hygiene. We tried to know if their children are enrolled in schools and what is their situation with education (including questions like which schools they attend, which classes they are in and all). We tried to establish communication and conduct awareness regarding their physical intimacy and cohabitation practices for both married and unmarried women. After knowing some of them are engaged in love relationships we tried to make them understand the right age for marriage and importance of financial stability in life. We tried to tell them about good touch and bad touch and the importance of saying No to your romantic partner if you do not consent on such physical intimacy. We also got to know about their interests in drawing classes and learning English and Computer. We also got to know they're facing with unemployment challenges presently. We also inspected the residential areas and found out the lack of toilets with basic sanitation lacking. And finally, we distributed Stayfree Sanitary pads packet to all these 12 women. And we assured to solve the above-mentioned issues in the upcoming month with the help of Rotary.



District Literacy Project Re-Think

On 28th September 2024, we organized the District Project Re-Think at Muktodhara, Naihati New Life Society, Naihati. We held a drawing competition and 29 kids studying at that institution participated in the event. The kids ranged from Class I to Class VI. The drawing topics was Draw As You Like. We provided drawing sheet, 1 pencil, 1 eraser and 1 sharpener to each kid and the time limit was set to 1 hour. Among the 29 participants, we picked 7 drawings out of which one was special recognition, and others were two sets of 3rd place, 2nd place and 1st place winners. We gave special gifts for those winners and everyone received a Participation certificate along with a Cadbury and a Pen. The special gifts included two Yellow-Red 80 grams Tennis Ball from Decathlon (3rd Prizes), two Quechua Green 0.75 L Water Bottle (2nd Prize) and two Apsara Big Art Set (1st Prize).



District Literacy Project Brainiac

On 28th September, RAC Durgapur Central Presidency organized District Project "Brainiac", a Quiz Competition at Mukhtodhara, Naihati where our Quiz Master Rtr. Sarthak Roy conducted an interesting quiz for children of all ages, and everyone took part actively. The quiz consisted of 20 questions and for every correct answer given by a participant, they received a gift pen as a token of appreciation for their efforts. The questions were kept really simple, according to the demographic of participants ranging from Class I to VI.





I am truly privileged to be named Rotaractor of the Month. I want to express my heartfelt thanks to my fellow Rotaractors, whose guidance and motivation have been instrumental in my journey with Rotaract. Let us continue our excellent work and strive to further empower our society together.



RTR. PRATISRUTI DUTTA

ROTARACTOR OF THE MONTH



RTR. SARTHAK ROY

It's a great pleasure to be the Rotaracter of the Month. I am grateful for getting this opportunity to work with so many great people. With their support I would continue to work in order to make a positive impact in this society.



JOIN US !

ROTA YEAR 2024-25

ROTARACT CLUB OF DURGAPUR CENTRAL PRESIDENCY

Sponsored by
Rotary Club of Durgapur Central
Rotaract District 3240

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JOIN OUR FAMILY

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